Travel and Expense Policy

Kestrel Ridge Technologies Ltd.

Document ID	Version	Effective date	Policy owner	Next review
FIN-POL-007	2.2	1 July 2026	Chief Financial Officer	30 June 2027

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This policy sets the rules for business travel and for claiming business expenses at Kestrel Ridge Technologies Ltd. It aims to keep employees safe and comfortable while controlling costs.

1.2 It applies to all employees travelling on Company business. Expenses for contractors are covered by their contracts.

2. Travel Approval and Booking

2.1 All business travel must be approved before booking, using the travel request form in the TravelDesk portal.

Type of travel	Approver	Book at least
Domestic, up to 3 nights	Reporting manager	14 days before travel
Domestic, more than 3 nights	Department head	14 days before travel
International	Department head and Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	21 days before travel

2.2 Flights and hotels must be booked through the Company travel agent via TravelDesk. Bookings made outside TravelDesk are reimbursed only if they are cheaper than the TravelDesk option and the manager approves the exception.

2.3 Late bookings (less than the minimum notice above) need a written reason from the approver.

3. Class of Travel

Employee grade	Flights up to 6 hours	Flights over 6 hours	Train
L1 - L3	Economy	Economy	AC 3-tier
L4 - L5	Economy	Premium economy	AC 2-tier
L6 and above	Economy	Business class	AC First class

3.1 Upgrades paid for by the Company are not allowed. Employees may upgrade at their own cost or using personal loyalty points.

4. Accommodation

4.1 The following are the maximum hotel rates per night, including taxes. Breakfast may be included in the room rate.

Location	Maximum rate per night
Tier 1 cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad)	INR 7,000
Tier 2 cities (for example Pune, Jaipur, Kochi, Ahmedabad)	INR 4,500
All other domestic locations	INR 3,000
International - London, New York, Tokyo, Singapore	USD 250
International - all other cities	USD 180

4.2 If an employee stays with friends or family instead of a hotel, they may claim a fixed amount of INR 1,000 per night (domestic) or USD 40 per night (international).

5. Daily Allowance (Per Diem)

5.1 A daily allowance covers meals, tips and small incidental costs. Receipts are not required for the daily allowance.

Employee grade	Domestic (per day)	International (per day)
L1 - L3	INR 1,200	USD 60
L4 - L5	INR 1,800	USD 75
L6 and above	INR 2,500	USD 100

5.2 Half the daily allowance is paid for the day of departure and the day of return if travel time on that day is less than 8 hours.

5.3 If meals are provided free (for example by a client or at a conference), the daily allowance is reduced by 25% for each main meal provided.

6. Local Transport

6.1 Employees should use app-based cabs, taxis or public transport for local travel.

6.2 Use of a personal vehicle for business is reimbursed at INR 12 per km for a car and INR 5 per km for a two-wheeler. Tolls and parking are reimbursed with receipts.

6.3 Car rentals require prior approval from the department head.

7. Meals and Client Entertainment

7.1 Client entertainment above INR 5,000 per event requires pre-approval from the department head. The claim must list the names and companies of all attendees.

7.2 Alcohol is not reimbursable, except as part of approved client entertainment.

8. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Traffic fines, parking fines and penalties.
- Hotel minibar, in-room movies and spa services.
- Personal entertainment, gym or sightseeing.
- Laundry on trips shorter than 4 nights.

- Seat or class upgrades (see Section 3.1).
- Lost personal items, or excess baggage for personal items.

9. Travel Advances

9.1 Employees may request a travel advance of up to 75% of the estimated trip cost (excluding flights and hotels booked through TravelDesk).

9.2 Advances must be settled by submitting an expense claim within 15 days of return. A new advance is not issued while a previous advance is unsettled.

10. Submitting Expense Claims

10.1 Expense claims must be submitted in TravelDesk within 30 days of returning from the trip. Claims submitted more than 60 days after return will not be reimbursed.

10.2 An original receipt or invoice is required for every expense above INR 500, except for the daily allowance.

10.3 Approved claims are paid to the employee's salary bank account within 10 working days of approval by Finance.

11. Corporate Credit Card

11.1 Employees at grade L5 and above who travel at least 4 times a year may apply for a corporate credit card. The card must be used only for business expenses.

11.2 Personal spending on a corporate card must be repaid within 7 days and repeated misuse will lead to the card being withdrawn.

12. Travel Insurance and Safety

12.1 All employees on approved business travel are automatically covered by the Company's group travel insurance, including medical emergencies, trip cancellation and lost baggage. No separate insurance needs to be purchased.

12.2 In an emergency while travelling, call the 24x7 travel assistance line at +91 80 4000 1234 and inform your manager as soon as possible.

12.3 Travel to countries rated "high risk" by the Company security advisor requires additional approval from the Chief Operating Officer.

13. Visas, Passports and Vaccinations

13.1 Visa fees, visa agent charges and mandatory vaccinations for business travel are reimbursed with receipts.

13.2 Passport application or renewal fees are not reimbursed, because a passport is a personal document.

14. Combining Business and Personal Travel

14.1 Employees may add up to 2 personal days to a business trip, with manager approval. Earned leave must be applied for the personal days.

14.2 The Company pays only the costs it would have paid for the business trip alone. Any extra airfare difference, hotel nights or other costs for personal days are paid by the employee. Family members may travel with the employee at their own cost.

15. Policy Violations

15.1 Submitting false or inflated claims is treated as fraud and may lead to disciplinary action, including termination. Questions about this policy can be sent to finance@kestrelridge.example.

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
2.0	1 July 2024	Introduced TravelDesk portal and city tier hotel limits.
2.1	1 January 2025	Increased mileage rate for cars from INR 10 to INR 12 per km.
2.2	1 July 2026	Added Sections 12 to 14 (insurance, visas, combined travel).